

Bomi K. Lee

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Academic Appointments

Visiting Assistant Professor

Department of Political Science, Bucknell University July 2025 - May 2026

Department of Political Science, University of Arkansas August 2024 - May 2025

National Science Foundation (NSF)-funded Post-doctoral Scholar

Department of Political Science, Washington University in St. Louis August 2022 - May 2024

Department of Political Science, University of Kentucky August 2021 - July 2022

Working with Dr. Tiffany D. Barnes and Dr. Diana Z. O'Brien in their NSF-funded research program on [Women as Leaders, Policy-Makers, and Symbols](#).

Education

Ph.D. Political Science, University of Iowa 2021

Dissertation: *Interconnected Rivalries*

Committee: Sara McLaughlin Mitchell (chair), Kelly M. Kadera, Brian Lai, Elizabeth Menninga, and Paul F. Diehl

MA, Political Science, University of Iowa 2019

MA, International Relations, Seoul National University (South Korea) 2013

BA, Political Science, Seoul National University (South Korea) 2011

Publications

[7] Bagwell, T. E., Dee, S. G., Luo, X., Stravato, A., Saikumar, D., Viens, F., Lee, B. K., O'Brien, D., & Mankin, J. S. "El Niño and Indian Ocean Dipole hydroclimate extremes heighten the risk of armed conflict." *PNAS* (Forthcoming)

[6] Barnes, Tiffany D., Bomi K. Lee, and Diana Z. O'Brien, "Shattered Pathways: Women's Appointment to Interior Ministries in the Wake of Terrorism." *The Journal of Politics* (Forthcoming)

[5] **Lee, Bomi K.** 2026. "Multiple Rivals and Leadership Approval: Evidence from Japan." *Foreign Policy Analysis* 22(1).

[4] **Lee, Bomi K.**, and Sojeong Lee. 2025. "Contested Boundaries in Changing Climates: Precipitation Variability and Interstate Diplomatic Conflict." *Environment and Security* 3(4): 555-576. DOI: [10.1177/27538796251333958](https://doi.org/10.1177/27538796251333958)

[3] **Lee, Bomi K.** 2023. "Triangles, Major Powers, and Rivalry Duration." *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 67(6): 1128-1154. DOI: [10.1177/00220027221134781](https://doi.org/10.1177/00220027221134781)

Earlier draft awarded the John Sprague Award (the best paper on political networks presented by a graduate student), issued by the Political Networks Section of APSA (2022)

[2] **Lee, Bomi K.**, Sara McLaughlin Mitchell, Cody J. Schmidt, and Yufan Yang. 2022. "Disasters and the Dynamics of Interstate Rivalry." *Journal of Peace Research* 59(1): 12-27. DOI: [10.1177/00223433211063333](https://doi.org/10.1177/00223433211063333)

[1] Schmidt, Cody J., **Bomi K. Lee**, and Sara McLaughlin Mitchell. 2021. "Climate Bones of Contention: How Climate Variability Influences Territorial, Maritime, and River Interstate Conflicts." *Journal of Peace Research* 58(1): 132-150. DOI: [10.1177/0022343320973738](https://doi.org/10.1177/0022343320973738)

Earlier draft awarded ISA Midwest's Frank J. Klingberg Best Paper Award (2019)

Book Chapter

[1] **Lee, Bomi K.** 2014. "North Korea's Peace Proposals in the 1970s," *Segye Jeongchi [World Politics]* 20: 323-370 [In Korean].

Working Papers

[2] **Lee, Bomi K.**, "Triangles, Mixed Alliance-Rivalry Dyads, and Conflict Propensity."

This paper examines how triangular configurations of rivalry and alliance ties influence conflict between countries. It finds that rivalries have a higher risk of militarized disputes when connected to third parties through mixed alliance-rivalry links, as rivals prioritize each other over mixed relationships. However, mixed alliance-rivalry dyads experience fewer disputes when embedded in alliance triangles that enable conflict management.

[1] **Lee, Bomi K.**, Cody J. Schmidt, and Sara McLaughlin Mitchell, "Paths to Peace in Issue Rivalries"

This paper moves beyond the dyadic rivalry context by considering how issue rivalry networks and extra-rivalry reputations influence peaceful and militarized conflict management in diplomatic issue conflicts. We capture interdependence by assessing the degree to which states are embedded in multiple rivalries using network analysis. We find that rivalry networks constrain militarization by target states in issue claims but have no effect on challengers.

Other Publications

[1] Barnes, Tiffany D., **Bomi K. Lee**, and Diana Z. O'Brien, "[Even After Albright, Foreign Policy Leaders Are Still Mostly Men](#)," *The Washington Post, Monkey Cage* (March 28, 2022).

Honors, Awards, and Grants

Travel Grant (\$150), American Political Science Association (2022)

The John Sprague Award (the best paper on political networks presented by a graduate student), "Triangles, Major Powers, and Rivalry Duration," Political Networks Section of APSA (2022)

Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award (\$1,000), University of Iowa (2021)

Graduate College Post-Comprehensive Research Fellowship (\$10,000), Graduate College, University of Iowa (2020)

Graduate College Summer Fellowship (\$5,000), Graduate College, University of Iowa (2020)

Travel Grant (\$150), International Studies Association-Midwest (2020)

Research Grant (\$1,000), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2020)

The Frank J. Klingberg Best Paper Award, Cody Schmidt, **Bomi Lee**, and Sara McLaughlin Mitchell, "Climate Bones of Contention", International Studies Association Midwest (2019)

Research Grant (\$1,400), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2019)

Research Grant (\$500), Graduate & Professional Student Government, University of Iowa (2019)

Travel Grant (\$200), American Political Science Association (2019)

Travel Grant (\$500), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2019)

NSF Fellowship (\$900), Political Networks Workshops & Conference (2019)

Travel Funds Award (\$750), Graduate Student Senate (GSS), University of Iowa (2019)

Best Course Paper Award, "Dissolution of Rivalries and Formation of Warm Peace," Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2018)

Travel Grant (\$550), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2018)

Summer Training Grant (\$3,300), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2017)

Travel Grant (\$600), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2017)

Research and Teaching Interests

International Relations: International Conflict and Cooperation, Interstate Rivalries, Interaction between Domestic and International Politics, Environmental Issues, Regional Security (East Asia)

Political Methodology: Introductory Statistics, Network Analysis, Time Series Analysis, Survival Analysis, Spatial Analysis, Survey Experiments

Research Experiences

University of Iowa

Countries Facing Multiple Rivals Project (online survey experiment in Japan) August 2019 -

Designed experiment/questionnaire and received the IRB approval (n=1,200).

Research Assistant on Project Haystack (with GoDaddy.com) for Prof. Caroline Tolbert and Prof. Karen Mossberger January 2021 - June 2021; September 2018 - December 2019

Cleaned raw data (n=20 million), visualized collapsed data (at the state/county/ZIP code levels), and conducted empirical analysis.

Research Assistant for Prof. Elizabeth Menninga Summer 2019

Combined civil war datasets (UCDP/PRIO Armed Conflict Dataset, Non-State Actors in Armed Conflict Dataset, etc), and visualized networks and empirical results.

Research Assistant on Issue Correlates of War (ICOW) Project for Prof. Sara McLaughlin Mitchell Summer 2017

Searched news stories for identity claims in Asia via LexisNexis.

The Institute for Far Eastern Studies (South Korea)

Research Intern for Prof. Jong-Dae Shin

March 2015 - October 2015

Searched and made a list of released governmental documents on the relationship between South Korea and North Korea.

Seoul National University (South Korea)

Research Assistant on East Asian International Relations Theory Project for Prof. Wookhee Shin

September 2012 - August 2015

Teaching Experiences

Bucknell University

International Politics

Fall 2025, Spring 2026

Quantitative Methods

Fall 2025

University of Arkansas

Introduction to International Relations

Spring 2025

Introduction to Comparative Politics

Fall 2024, Spring 2025

University of Iowa

Guest Lecturer for Advanced Methodology (Graduate-Level)

Fall 2021

Taught the concept of centrality in networks and how to use R to calculate various centrality measures.

Instructor for Analyzing Political Data

Spring 2020

(Online) Teaching Assistant for Consequences of War

Spring 2021

Teaching Assistant for Introduction to International Relations

Fall 2016/2017, Spring 2018

(Online) Teaching Assistant for Introduction to International Relations

Summer 2018

Teaching Assistant for Introduction to American Politics

Spring 2017

Iowa Social Science Research Center, University of Iowa

Statistical Consultant

Fall 2019 - Spring 2021

Taught workshops: Introduction and Data Management Using R, Network Visualization Using R, and Network Analysis Using R

ICPSR Summer Program, University of Michigan

Teaching Assistant for Time Series Analysis 1

Summer 2019

Taught six computer lab sessions with Dr. Desmond Wallace, and graded assignments.

Seoul National University (South Korea)

Teaching Assistant for Introduction to International Relations

Fall 2011

Additional Training

ICPSR Summer Program, University of Michigan

Summer 2017

Game Theory 1 & Rational Choice Theories of Politics and Society

ISRC Workshops, University of Iowa

Fall 2018

Python Basics

Invited Talks and Workshops

Journeys in World Politics, University of Iowa (2022)

Political Networks (PolNet), "Introduction to Network Analysis in R" (2022, 2023, 2024): invited as an instructor

Visions in Methodology (VIM), Claremont Graduate University (2021)

Department of Political Science, Rice University (2021)

University of Alabama's ISSR Workshop on International Conflict (2020): canceled due to the COVID-19

Minnesota Political Methodology Graduate Student Colloquium (2019)

Conferences

Paper Presentations

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2020, 2022)

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (co-author) (2019, 2021)

International Studies Association Annual Conference (2021, 2022, 2023)

International Studies Association Annual Conference (co-author) (2022, 2024)

International Studies Association Midwest Annual Conference (2017, 2018, 2019, 2020)

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2018, 2026)

Peace Science Society Annual Meeting (co-author) (2019, 2020)

Political Networks (2022)

Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2022)

Conference Within A Conference on Rethinking Disaster Politics and Policy

Poster Presentations

International Studies Association Annual Conference (2020): canceled due to the COVID-19

Peace Science Society Annual Meeting (2019, 2023)

Political Networks (2019)

Professional Affiliations

American Political Science Association

International Studies Association

Peace Science Society

Disciplinary Service

Referee

American Political Science Review
Asian Security
British Journal of Political Science
Conflict Management and Peace Science
Foreign Policy Analysis
International Interactions
International Studies Quarterly
Journal of Peace Research
Journal of Politics
Political Geography
Review of International Organizations

Award Committees

John Sprague Award issued by the Political Networks Section of APSA, Chair (2024)
John Sprague Award issued by the Political Networks Section of APSA (2023)

Section Service

Program Committee, Political Networks, Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2025, 2026)
Communications Director, Political Networks Section of APSA (2023-2025)

Departmental Service

Scholarships Committee, Department of Political Science, University of Arkansas (2025)
Instructor, Math Camp for incoming graduate students, Department of Political Science, University of Iowa (2019, 2020)